



SEMAPHORE TRAFFIC SYSTEM

Document ID: SH-J2-SEMAPHORE-001 | **Version:** 1.0.0 | **State:** LOCKED DIRECTION

Owner: Orientation | **Related:** Canon, Judgment, EIB, provenance, temporal integrity | **Cross-reference:** PROVENANCE_AND_LINEAGE.md; TEMPORAL_INTEGRITY.md; AI_AUTHORITY_AND_HUMAN_AUTHORSHIP.md

Semaphore is the cable-like longitudinal intelligence/decision traffic medium: durable, searchable, threaded, referential, supersession-aware, historically navigable, and human-authored. It is not Slack with formal typography and not a one-page cap on major decisions.

Traffic retains durable ID, human originator, issue/event time, subject stating why it matters, concise point-first opening, references/thread, distribution/access, business line/topics, related decisions/problems, corrections/supersession, and priority where useful. Routine/Priority/Immediate/Flash remain PROVISIONAL labels. Orientation Officers exercise professional judgment over what merits traffic; policy does not enumerate every allowed subject.

The record captures decisions, relied-upon judgments, alternatives, assumptions, unknowns, dissent, evidence references, predictions, triggers, later changes, and supersession—not every hallway conversation, private thought, or interpersonal influence chain. Retention follows future legal/privacy rules while preserving provenance wherever lawful.

AI may assist research; only a human Orientation Officer writes/issues institutional traffic. Daedalus cannot author, issue, or promote a cable.

Institutional purpose

Semaphore carries the institution's evolving understanding across time and organizational distance. It is not chat, email, a ticket queue, a document repository, or a one-page decision memo. A cable can report a change, anomaly, field condition, consequential interpretation, correction, dissent, decision context, or other matter that an Orientation Officer judges worthy of durable institutional traffic. The medium remains broad because professional judgment—not an eligibility checklist—determines what deserves a cable.

Cable construction

The subject tells a reader why the traffic matters rather than merely naming a project. The opening states the point concisely. The body preserves enough context, evidence references, assumptions, confidence, alternatives, unknowns, and dissent for a future reader to understand the issue without pretending one cable is the entire record.

A durable cable ID never changes. Origin identifies the human issuing office/officer. Event, issue, and record times remain distinguishable. Distribution reflects information nature and need, not prestige. References create explicit threads across earlier/later cables, Judgment Problems, decisions, Canon states, EIB items, JAG deployments, finance assumptions, and source material.

Possible Routine, Priority, Immediate, and Flash precedence language remains PROVISIONAL. Precedence, if adopted, communicates handling urgency rather than truth, importance forever, or author rank.

Threading, correction, and supersession

A reply or follow-on references the earlier cable while remaining its own record. A correction states what was wrong, what changes, why, and which downstream readers or artifacts may be affected. Supersession identifies the new controlling traffic without making the prior cable disappear. A cable may remain historically significant even when its conclusion is wrong.

Thread navigation supports chronological reading, branch/alternative interpretation, forward reliance, backward sourcing, and related-topic traversal. Traffic concerning transportation scheduling, for example, remains discoverable across years even when authors used different project names.

Authorship and accountability

The Orientation Officer exercises judgment about issue, framing, distribution, and record state and is accountable for the issued traffic. AI can retrieve, compare, challenge, and support research, but an officer must independently understand and author the cable. There is no “approve generated draft” process that makes Daedalus the hidden institutional author.

Semaphore records the institutional mind—not a forensic influence map. It preserves relied-upon judgments, assumptions, dissent, alternatives, predictions, and change. It does not attempt to capture every conversation or assign later blame for private interpersonal influence.

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